```
        "lte": "22-05-2023||-2d"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

The anchor date followed by || minus two days

The `range` query's `lte` operator takes a date value expressed as date math. In this case, 22-05-2023 is the anchor date, and we subtract two days from it (`-2d`). (Elasticsearch has a dictionary of letters for date math: *y* for years, *M* for months, *w* for weeks, *d* for days, *h* for hours, *m* for minutes, *s* for seconds, and so on.)

Instead of specifying the current date, Elasticsearch lets us use a keyword: `now`. The `now` keyword represents the current date. For example, using `now-1y` sets the date to one year ago:

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "range": {
      "release_date": {
         "gte": "now-1y"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Fetches all the movies from last year: the current date (represented as now) minus one year

We build the `release_date` expression by using `now` and subtracting one year from it.

There are many options to manipulate dates in Elasticsearch, and I advise you to consult the documentation to learn more. Note that Elasticsearch doesn't cache queries containing date math, so there are performance implications when using date math in `range` queries.

In the next section, we look at `wildcard` queries. These queries don't let us down if we provide partial search criteria, because we use wildcards to build up the expression.

## 9.7 The wildcard query

As their name implies, `wildcard` queries let us search for words with missing characters, suffixes, and prefixes. For example, suppose we want to search for all possible combinations of movies with titles ending in *father* or *god*, even if they are missing a single character like *god?ather*. This is where we can use a `wildcard` query. The `wildcard` query accepts an asterisk (`*`) or a question mark (`?`) in the search word, as described in table 9.2.

**Table 9.2 Types of wildcards**

| Character | Description |
|---|---|
| * (asterisk) | Searches for zero or more characters |
| ? (question mark) | Searches for a single character |